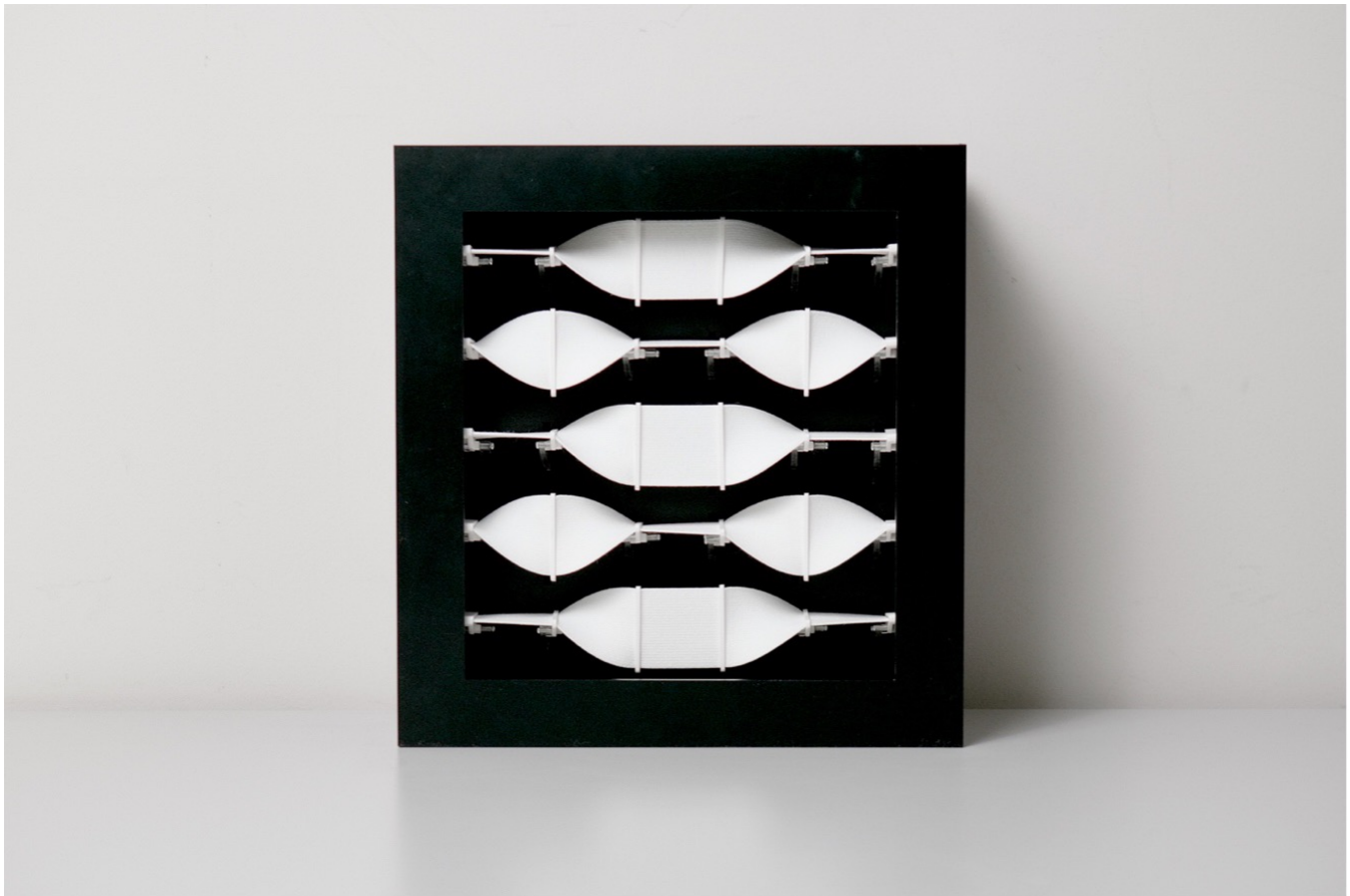


Hinemosu 30

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1 PROJECT URL

<https://www.katsumotoy.com/>
<https://sites.google.com/view/utsuroi/>

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2 DESCRIPTION OF ARTWORK

Humans draw lines to write letters and sketch pictures. Computers use dots, or pixels, to represent texts and graphics. Then, if a computer controls a linear and not discrete physical object, what kind of image would emerge? This is what I am interested in, and I had been explored kinetic typography by manipulating slender objects such as springs and strings with robot arms. Beyond those practices, I have currently focused on flat lines such as strips, ribbons, and tapes which have two sides with very different widths. Those lines change in apparent thickness depending on the viewpoint. For example, if the ribbon is tilted 90 degrees, the line will appear or disappear. If it is twisted from both ends, the line weight changes continuously like a sine wave. Lines drawn by humans with a brush or calligraphy pen also have continuous changes in line weight. Inspired by this similarity, I began exploring kinetic typography and motion graphics using elastic bands.



Hinemosu 30 displays letters and patterns by twisting five white elastic bands with thirty actuators and represents life and time. Five lines of ever-changing width can display a variety of motion graphics. I have created them with motifs such as textile patterns, ocean waves, mountain storm, and snowfall. The mechanical noise made by the servo motors evoke the sounds of water and wind in nature. Also, by switching the line thickness, Arabic numerals and Roman alphabets can be displayed.

3 ARTIST INFORMATION

Yuichiro Katsumoto is an artist of gadget making and an educator. He creates transformable objects to change our daily routines, common senses, and stereotypes. He studied video production and interaction design at Keio University SFC. After completing graduate school, he moved to Singapore and worked in R&D at the National University of Singapore for 8 years. In October 2018, he returned to Japan to launch his own studio, Katsumotoy. Since 2019, he has been teaching art and design at Tokyo Denki University.

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